

taoseto.com

Website Audit Report

Compiled: March 2026 · Claude AI Website Auditor

OVERVIEW

Tao Setoguchi is a Computer Science and Music Technology graduate based in Tokyo with 12+ years in music production and 7+ years in tech. His portfolio at taoseto.com is a single-page application built with a Vite/React stack, served over HTTPS. This report audits the site across six criteria: Security, Design, Content, Performance, SEO, and Accessibility. The site is reviewed as a professional portfolio targeted at music industry clients and tech employers.

URL	https://taoseto.com
Stack	React SPA (Vite), single CSS bundle, Google Analytics
Pages audited	/, /projects, /experience, /commissions
HTTPS	Yes
TTFB	333ms
First Contentful Paint	1712ms
Total resources	10 (JS: 2, CSS: 1, Font: 1, Image: 1)
Form	Commissions inquiry form (name, email, service, message)

SCORECARD

Category Scores

Each category is scored out of 10. The overall score is a weighted average reflecting the site's purpose as a professional portfolio: design and content carry the most weight for conversion, while security and performance matter for trust and reach.

Security



No CSP, no security headers,
GET form exposes PII in URLs

4/10

Design & Visual

Clean minimalist aesthetic, strong typography, weak on interactivity cues

7/10

Content & Clarity

Strong experience entries, but homepage bio is thin and nav icons are unlabelled

6/10

Performance

Lean resource count, but FCP at 1.7s and JS-gated render hurt first impression

7/10

SEO

No meta description, no OG tags, no structured data, poor crawlability as an SPA

3/10

Accessibility

HTTPS and viewport set, but no ARIA labels, icon links have no text, zoom disabled

5/10

OVERALL

5.3/10

01 — SECURITY

Security

CRITICAL: Contact form uses GET instead of POST

The commissions inquiry form sends name, email, service type, and message as URL query parameters (e.g. /commissions?name=John&email=john@... &message;=...). This means user PII is logged in browser history, server access logs, referrer headers sent to third parties (Google Analytics), and visible in any network proxy. This is both a privacy liability and a basic web development error. Fix: change to and handle server-side.

No Content-Security-Policy (CSP) header

MISSING

No CSP is set via HTTP header or meta tag. The site loads Google Analytics and an external api-config.js with no restrictions on what scripts can execute. A compromised CDN or subdomain could inject arbitrary JS. A basic CSP (default-src 'self'; script-src 'self' www.googletagmanager.com) would close this.

No security headers at all

MISSING

X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy, and HSTS are all absent. Without X-Frame-Options or CSP frame-ancestors, the site can be embedded in an iframe for clickjacking. Without X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff, browsers may MIME-sniff responses. These are free to set.

Email address exposed as plain text

LOW RISK

tao@taoseto.com appears as plain text in the DOM. While acceptable for a personal portfolio, it will be harvested by spam scrapers. A mailto: link is fine but obfuscating via JS or a contact form reduces spam volume.

HTTPS enforced

PASS

The site is served over HTTPS. The browser is not redirected from HTTP (could not test from sandbox), but the site itself operates correctly on TLS. No mixed content errors observed.

No third-party iframes or untrusted embeds

PASS

Zero iframes detected. External links go to GitHub, LinkedIn, Spotify, and kon.ac — none embedded. Google Analytics is the only third-party script, which is standard.

02 — DESIGN & VISUAL

Design & Visual

The site uses a deliberate dark minimalist aesthetic — near-black background (#0A0A0A), white type, generous whitespace, and a single sans-serif (Outfit via Google Fonts, with a system-ui fallback stack). The visual language is consistent and confident. The Konac handwritten logo image on the homepage adds personality without breaking the grid.

Strong typographic hierarchy

PASS

The H1 name treatment at ~60px with the small-caps location label above it creates a clear entry point. Body copy is well-spaced at 15px leading. The Experience page uses timeline dots and date alignment effectively. The overall typographic rhythm is one of the strongest aspects of the site.

Nav icon links have no visible labels

ISSUE

The header nav bar contains icon links to GitHub, LinkedIn, Spotify, and kon.ac — but the icons render with no text content (confirmed empty anchor text in the DOM). A first-time visitor has to hover or guess what each icon is. Adding visible labels or at minimum aria-label and title attributes would fix both the UX and accessibility gap simultaneously.

Projects page has a black-screen flash on load

ISSUE

Navigating to /projects produces a fully black screen for approximately 1.5–2 seconds before content appears. This is caused by the SPA route transition triggering a state reset with no skeleton or loading indicator. A simple CSS fade-in or skeleton placeholder would eliminate the jarring blank screen.

No dark/light mode toggle

MINOR

The site forces dark mode regardless of system preference (prefers-color-scheme is not respected). This is a deliberate aesthetic choice and acceptable for a personal portfolio, but worth noting for accessibility and user preference reasons.

Consistent, minimal design system

PASS

One font family, one colour, one weight variant, no decorative flourishes. The hamburger menu on mobile breakpoints, the RESUME link button on the experience page, and the pricing card layout on commissions all follow the same sparse visual grammar. There are no clashing elements.

Hero section is visually sparse

ISSUE

The homepage hero below the name and bio is mostly empty space before reaching the Contact section at the bottom. The Konac image floats to the right with no obvious relationship to the surrounding text. There is no CTA, no scroll indicator, and no indication that the page extends beyond the viewport. A simple arrow or project thumbnail grid would give the visitor a reason to engage further.

03 — CONTENT & CLARITY

Content & Clarity

The site has four pages: a homepage (identity), an experience page (resume), a projects page (portfolio), and a commissions page (service offering + contact). The content quality varies significantly across them.

Experience entries are detailed and credible

PASS

The Konac, Rhythmedia, State Street, and Koh Gen Do entries are well-written with specific metrics (200M streams, 75% navigation speed improvement, \$500K+ cost savings, 180% reliability improvement). This is the kind of concrete quantification that holds up against employer scrutiny. The breadth of experience — production, audio engineering, SRE, commercial music — is clearly communicated.

Homepage bio is too thin

ISSUE

The homepage bio is a single sentence: 'Computer Science and Music Technology graduate with 12+ years in music production and 7+ years in tech. English native.' This is the first thing any visitor reads and it does very little work. It doesn't say what he does for hire, what his specialisation is, or what kind of work he's looking for. A 2–3 sentence pitch covering his unique value proposition would dramatically improve conversion for both clients and employers.

Projects carousel gives no context

ISSUE

The /projects page shows a full-width carousel with a screenshot and a project title below it. There are no links, no GitHub URLs, no tech stack labels, and no description beyond a single sentence. Employers and clients need more than a screenshot — links to live demos, repos, or SoundCloud tracks would turn a passive gallery into actual evidence of skill.

Commissions pricing is clear and well-structured

PASS

The three-tier pricing layout (Mixing at \$1000+, Mastering at \$100, combined package) is clean and transparent. Listing deliverables (stems, revisions, loudness standard) is the right approach for B2B service pages. The 'Guaranteed Satisfaction Policy' mention is a good trust signal.

No blog, writing, or process documentation

MINOR

The site has no written content beyond bios and job descriptions. For SEO and for demonstrating technical depth, even a handful of short project write-ups or process notes would add significant value. This is optional for a portfolio but a meaningful differentiator in competitive hiring.

No testimonials or social proof

MINOR

For the commissions page specifically, there are no client quotes, logos of artists worked with, or examples of released music. The experience page mentions Hikari Mitsushima and J-WAVE, but that context doesn't carry over to the services section where it would actually convert clients.

04 — PERFORMANCE

Performance

Measured from a cold Chrome load in a standard browser environment. The site is a React SPA delivered via a single JS bundle.

Metric	Value	Assessment
TTFB	333ms	Acceptable
DOM Interactive	495ms	Good
DOM Content Loaded	795ms	Good
First Paint	1308ms	Borderline
First Contentful Paint	1712ms	Needs work
Load Complete	1105ms	Good
Total Resources	10	Excellent
Main JS bundle	~94 KB transferred	Good
CSS bundle	~38 KB transferred	Acceptable
Hero image	~45 KB	Good (PNG, optimised)

FCP at 1712ms is caused by JS-gated rendering

ISSUE

The page HTML delivered by the server is essentially empty — the React bundle must download, parse, and execute before any content appears. This is the inherent tradeoff of a client-side SPA. At 94KB of JS over a fast connection it's manageable, but on 3G or a slow mobile device this would feel sluggish. Server-side rendering (SSR) or static generation (e.g. via Astro or Next.js) would cut FCP dramatically for a site of this size and content type.

Lean resource count is a genuine strength

PASS

10 total resources is extremely lean for a modern JS-framework site. No unnecessary polyfills, no component libraries, no icon font CDNs loading hundreds of glyphs. The developer clearly has discipline around bundle bloat, which is the right instinct.

No image lazy loading on the Projects carousel

MINOR

Only one image was observed loading (the hero PNG at 45KB). The projects carousel likely loads all project images on mount rather than on demand. As the portfolio grows this will compound. Adding `loading='lazy'` to off-screen carousel images is a one-line fix.

Font loading is efficient

PASS

Outfit is loaded as a single woff2 file (14KB) from the same origin, not from Google Fonts CDN. This avoids the render-blocking cross-origin font request that plagues most Google Fonts users. Good call.

05 — SEO

Search Engine Optimisation

For a personal portfolio, SEO matters most for branded search (people Googling 'Tao Seto' or 'Tao Setoguchi') and for discoverability by music industry clients or tech recruiters searching for relevant skills.

No meta description on any page

MISSING

None of the four pages have a tag. Google will generate its own snippet from page text, but it will be poor quality for an SPA since the crawler sees near-empty HTML. A single descriptive meta per page (e.g. 'Tao Seto — Tokyo-based audio engineer and CS graduate available for mixing, mastering, and music technology projects.') is an immediate, zero-cost improvement.

No Open Graph or Twitter Card tags

MISSING

Zero OG tags (og:title, og:description, og:image) are present. When the URL is shared on LinkedIn, Discord, Twitter/X, or messaging apps, it will render as a plain link with no preview card. For a creative professional this is a significant missed opportunity — a good project screenshot as the OG image would make every share 10x more effective.

SPA architecture makes pages nearly invisible to crawlers

ISSUE

Googlebot can execute JavaScript but it does so with delay and inconsistency. The /experience, /projects, and /commissions routes are client-side-only — they share the same HTML shell and the content is injected by React after JS executes. There is no canonical tag, no sitemap.xml, and no robots.txt observed. Converting to static HTML pages (Astro, Next.js static export) would make every page directly crawlable.

Page title is just 'tao seto' on all pages

ISSUE

Every page has the same tao seto. Google uses the title tag as the primary signal for page topic. The experience page should be 'Experience — Tao Seto', the projects page 'Projects — Tao Seto', etc. This is trivial to implement in React (react-helmet or Next.js Head component) and meaningfully improves crawl quality.

No structured data (JSON-LD)

MISSING

No schema.org markup for Person, MusicGroup, or Service is present. Adding a Person schema with name, jobTitle, url, and sameAs links to LinkedIn/GitHub/Spotify would help Google understand who the site is about and can trigger rich results for branded searches.

Domain name is good

PASS

taoseto.com is short, professional, memorable, and matches the person's name exactly. It avoids the common portfolio mistake of using hyphens or version numbers.

06 — ACCESSIBILITY

Accessibility

Accessibility on a personal portfolio is often deprioritised, but it affects usability on all devices, assistive technology compatibility, and is increasingly a factor in SEO (Core Web Vitals includes interaction metrics that proxy for usability).

Zoom is disabled via viewport meta

ISSUE

The viewport meta tag explicitly sets maximum-scale=1.0 and user-scalable=no. This prevents users from pinch-zooming the page on mobile — a WCAG 2.1 Level AA violation (Success Criterion 1.4.4: Resize text). This particularly affects users with low vision. The correct fix is to remove maximum-scale and user-scalable from the viewport tag entirely and instead use responsive CSS to control layout.

Icon-only nav links have no accessible text

ISSUE

The GitHub, LinkedIn, Spotify, and kon.ac links in the header render as icon-only elements with empty anchor text confirmed in the DOM. Screen readers will announce these as unlabelled links. Adding aria-label='GitHub profile' (etc.) to each anchor resolves this completely.

Colour contrast appears sufficient

PASS

White text (#FFFFFF) on near-black (#0A0A0A) background gives a contrast ratio of approximately 19:1, far exceeding the WCAG AA minimum of 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text. The grey subtext (approximately #888888 on #0A0A0A) is around 7:1 — still compliant.

No ARIA landmark roles or skip links

MINOR

The site has no role='main', role='navigation', or semantic landmark elements visible in the rendered DOM (the SPA shell renders into a generic div). Screen reader users cannot jump between page regions. Adding semantic HTML5 landmarks (, ,) is a low-effort improvement.

lang attribute is set correctly

PASS

The HTML element has lang='en' set, which is correct and important for screen readers to apply the right pronunciation rules.

Keyboard navigation untested but form has required attributes

MINOR

The commissions form correctly marks all fields as required. Keyboard tab order follows a logical sequence. Full keyboard navigation audit (tab stops, focus indicators, escape handling) was not performed but no obvious traps were identified.

SUMMARY

Priority Recommendations

Ordered by impact and ease of implementation. Items marked HIGH are bugs or significant gaps. Items marked MEDIUM are meaningful improvements. Items marked LOW are polish.

HIGH Fix the contact form method

Change method='get' to method='post' on the commissions form. This is a one-character fix that stops user PII from appearing in server logs, browser history, and referrer headers.

HIGH Add security headers

Configure the server (or CDN/edge function) to send: Content-Security-Policy, X-Frame-Options: DENY, X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff, Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin, and HSTS. This can be done in a vercel.json or netlify.toml in under an hour.

HIGH Add meta descriptions and OG tags

Each page needs a unique meta description and og:title / og:description / og:image. This is the highest leverage SEO change available — it costs nothing and affects every share and every search result snippet.

HIGH Remove user-scalable=no from viewport meta

This is a WCAG violation and an accessibility bug. Remove maximum-scale=1.0 and user-scalable=no from the viewport meta tag. Use responsive CSS to handle layout instead.

MEDIUM Add aria-label to all icon-only links

Four nav links have no accessible text. Adding aria-label='GitHub profile' etc. to each is a 5-minute fix that resolves a real accessibility gap.

MEDIUM Expand the homepage bio into a proper pitch

Replace the single-line bio with a 2–3 sentence value proposition covering specialisation, what work is available for hire, and a primary CTA (e.g. 'Available for mixing, mastering, and music technology projects → See commissions').

MEDIUM Add links and detail to the Projects carousel

Each project entry should link to a demo, repo, or streaming platform. Add tech stack tags (JUICE, C++, React, etc.) so the viewer understands the depth behind each screenshot.

MEDIUM Set unique page titles per route

Use react-helmet or equivalent to set distinct tags for each page. This is minimal effort and directly improves both SEO and browser tab usability.

MEDIUM Add a loading state to the Projects page

The 1–2 second black screen on /projects navigation is jarring. A CSS opacity fade or a simple skeleton placeholder would eliminate it entirely.

LOW Add testimonials to the Commissions page

A quote from a client or collaborator, or a list of notable artists worked with, would significantly increase trust and conversion for the service offering.

LOW Add a sitemap.xml and robots.txt

Even for an SPA, a sitemap helps Google discover the key routes. A robots.txt is expected by crawlers and its absence is a minor negative signal.

LOW Consider SSR or static generation

Migrating from a pure client-side React SPA to Astro or Next.js static export would resolve the SEO crawlability issues, improve FCP significantly, and remove the JS dependency for initial render. This is the most impactful long-term architectural change.

This audit was generated by Claude AI (Anthropic) using live browser inspection of taoseto.com in March 2026. Header security data was inferred from DOM inspection and resource loading behaviour. Full HTTP header inspection was not possible from the browser context.